Nikhil Pawar

Seattle, WA (open to relocation) | nikhil.k.pawar.06@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/nikhil-pawar0609 | github.com/aimsotrash

Education

Northeastern University — Seattle, WA
Master of Science in Computer Science, GPA 4.0/4.0 — *Expected Dec 2027*

- **Coursework:** Scalable Distributed Systems, Fundamentals of Cloud Computing, Algorithms

Presidency University — Bangalore, India
Bachelor of Technology in Information Science Engineering — *Jun 2022*

Technical Skills

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, IAM, EMR, Kinesis, VPC, SSM), Terraform, Terragrunt, Proxmox
Containers & CI/CD: Docker, Kubernetes (k3s), Argo CD, Atlantis, Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Git
Data & Databases: Apache Airflow, SQL, Redshift, RDS, Hive, MySQL, SQLite
Observability & Incident Response: CloudWatch, PagerDuty, Prometheus, Grafana
Languages & Systems: Linux, Python (Boto3), Bash, systemd, FastAPI, TypeScript, React
ML/AI: Drift detection, Time-series forecasting, Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG)

Experience

DevOps Engineer | HP Inc — Pune, India | Aug 2022 – Dec 2025

- Administered the AWS account behind HP's commercial device telemetry platform, ingesting from millions of enterprise devices through Kinesis into a petabyte-scale, five-tier lake on S3, Hive/RDS, and Redshift. Provisioned EMR jobs and infrastructure for new sources as often as daily during device launches.
- Automated GDPR erasure as Python workflows on Apache Airflow, replacing manual ingestion pauses, MSCK REPAIR passes, and hand-restarted deletion jobs that could sit failed all weekend. Cut turnaround from up to a month to 48 hours, inside the two-week compliance window.
- Managed account infrastructure as code with Terraform and Terragrunt, authoring modules, maintaining an inherited codebase, and migrating Terraform state out of a relinquished AWS account into one the team owned.
- Built and maintained Azure DevOps pipelines on self-hosted HP agents, deploying Terraform, Lambda, and EMR jobs to AWS so infrastructure changes shipped from a git commit.
- Owned end-to-end remediation of security findings (access reviews, vulnerability patching) and authored IAM roles and policies from scratch, including cross-account data-sharing roles and scoped permissions replacing broad ones.
- Shared a rotating production on-call, triaging job and pipeline failures through CloudWatch alarms and PagerDuty, with alerting on cluster health, data freshness, and storage.

DevOps Engineer Intern | HP Inc — Pune, India | Mar 2022 – Jul 2022

- Built CI/CD pipelines and logging/monitoring for cloud-native services on AWS. Converted to full-time after five months.

Projects

Self-Healing Infrastructure | GitHub — 2026

- Built an EC2 web server that heals itself: a CloudWatch alarm on a custom nginx health metric invokes a Python Lambda, which restarts nginx through SSM Run Command with no inbound SSH.
- Provisioned the whole stack with Terraform, including least-privilege IAM roles that limit metric writes to one namespace and SSM commands to one instance.

Private Cloud Infrastructure | GitHub — 2026

- Deployed a multi-node private cloud on bare-metal Proxmox with Terraform-driven VM provisioning, running plan/apply through Atlantis and GitHub Actions on every pull request.
- Ran a heterogeneous Kubernetes (k3s) cluster across machines joined by a Tailscale overlay, including a GPU worker node, with Argo CD for GitOps delivery and Prometheus/Grafana for observability.

StreamLoRA (in progress) | GitHub — 2026

- Building a continual-learning forecaster for laptop telemetry with drift detection and gated model promotion that rolls back changes that make forecasts worse.
- Collects 38 signals from 8 sources every 5 seconds and scores every forecast against persistence, moving-average, EWMA, and linear baselines with chronological, embargoed evaluation.

Cipherlink | GitHub — 2026

- Built a peer-to-peer encrypted messenger on the MLS protocol (RFC 9420) over WebRTC DataChannels, treating the server-run key directory as untrusted with safety-number verification and outgoing messages held on key change.

Certifications & Leadership

Judges' Choice Award – Defense Tech Jam Seattle – *2026*